Stratoscan — Shark Tank pitch

Oct 4, 2026 · @Chetan Tanay

Start a new Claude Code session on the branch `claude/fervent-noether-r1v38j` of `tanay-bot/stratoscan`, then paste the prompt below. The `/shark` skill lives on that branch only (`.claude/skills/shark/`), so a session on `main` will not have it until the branch is merged.

How to run it

1. Open a new Claude Code session on `tanay-bot/stratoscan`, branch `claude/fervent-noether-r1v38j`.
2. Optional: turn on accept-edits mode (Shift+Tab) so you are not asked to approve each file the sharks write.
3. Paste this prompt:

```
/shark Read the Claude Doc at https://claude.ai/code/artifact/94c6408a-acc9-49ca-b89d-dc0efcab8ed7 with your docs or Artifact read tool. The section "The pitch file" is the pitch: use it word for word as .shark/pitch.md, and append the section "What the pitch does not contain" to it too. Do not add facts, numbers or opinions that are not in those two sections.
```

4. When it finishes, the session prints `BOARD.md`: how many sharks are in, each decision and practice offer, what would change their minds, and a homework list of questions the pitch could not answer.

For a bigger panel, start the prompt with `/shark --investors 10` (21 sub-agent calls instead of 11).

What /shark does

`/shark` puts a business idea in front of a Shark Tank-style panel of Claude sub-agents who are told to look for a reason to say no. It is a free, MIT-licensed skill by Alex Chen (source), installed unchanged in this repo. It writes only inside `.shark/` and makes no outside calls.

Step	Who	Output
1. Grill	Each shark (5 by default)	Biggest worry + 3 hardest questions
2. Answer	One founder sub-agent	Answers from the pitch only; anything missing is marked NOT ANSWERED and becomes homework
3. Decide	Each shark	IN or OUT, a practice offer, one-line reason, what would change their mind
4. Board	The script	`BOARD.md`: deal count, panel table, mind-changers, homework list

The default panel is the Tech Billionaire, Royalty, Customer, Numbers and Skeptic sharks. A `--seed` or a different `--investors` count draws from all ten, which add Market, Operator, Brand, Legal and Long-Game sharks.

The sharks and founder see only the pitch file, never the conversation. That is why the pitch below must stand on its own. Offers are practice numbers from language models, not real money and not financial advice.

The pitch file

Stratoscan: a free, natural-language stock screener and 10-year backtester for US stocks, launched as a product people will come back to.

What it is

- Tagline: "Bridge from idea to candidate list. A natural-language market terminal with 10 years of backtested history — free, forever."
- A user types a strategy in plain English (for example, "find undervalued small-cap tech stocks with rising momentum"). The app turns it into filters, screens about 5,000 US exchange-listed stocks, then simulates the strategy on 10 years of daily prices, including trading fees, slippage, stop-losses and short selling, and compares it with holding the S&P 500 (SPY).
- Each result shows robustness checks: Monte Carlo simulation, bootstrap confidence intervals, walk-forward testing and parameter sensitivity.
- Scope: US stocks and ETFs only. Crypto, futures, forex and commodities are ruled out on purpose: "every one of them dilutes the verification claim that is your whole position."

Price and revenue

- Free, with no paywall and no paid tier. Accounts exist only so usage can be rate-limited per person.
- A `plan` field is kept in the database for possible future use. A payment system was built and then removed.

Costs

- Near-zero cost per user. A rule-based parser interprets most queries at no cost; an AI model is called only for the roughly 20% it cannot read, and answers are cached for 24 hours. The screener makes zero outside calls per query.
- Everything runs on free tiers: Neon (database), Upstash (rate limits), Finnhub (10 free keys), yfinance (price history), free AI models and SendGrid (email). One small always-on server is planned at about $2–3 a month.

Customers so far

- None. Not launched. Nothing is deployed; it runs only on the founder's laptop.

How users will find it

- The plan is to let a stranger run a real backtest without an account and share the result as a link: "after value, never before." No-signup trials and shareable links are not built yet.

What makes it different, in the founder's words

- Verification is the position: "every number is correct" is the core claim. An automated accuracy loop re-derives every reported number from first principles (14,294 of 14,294 checks passing), and a frozen set of reference results fails the build if the simulation math changes without approval.
- Every result carries a disclaimer: simulated results on historical data, past performance does not predict future results, not investment advice.

Team and build

- A solo founder who describes their own coding ability as limited. The software was built largely with AI coding agents (Freebuff / DeepSeek, and Claude). The core engine was built in about five days.

- About 49 server-side test suites and 240 on the frontend; security review of sign-in and sessions; Google sign-in, password reset, account deletion, usage tracking and error capture.

Timeline

- A written 15-day plan from working prototype to "deployment-ready." Days 1–4 are done: local production setup, background data jobs, full account system, usage tracking and legal pages.
- Still ahead: a first backtest in under 60 seconds (today it can take minutes on cold data); no-signup trials and shareable result links; templates; retention features; "explain the result"; a testing push; a deployment dress rehearsal.

How success is measured

- Kill criterion: the share of users who run a second backtest, called "the single most important number in the product." It also tracks whether users return on day 2 and day 7.

Known constraints and risks

- Email: the free tier allows 100 emails a day, and signup is capped at 50 a day site-wide to stay under it.
- Email deliverability: without a domain set up for email authentication, verification emails may land in spam. Not yet resolved.
- Data: price history comes from yfinance, an unofficial library that reads Yahoo Finance. An alternative licensed source (London Strategic Edge) is prepared but untested against the live service; its licence forbids showing its prices to end users.
- Every external service is on a free plan with its own limits; caching and hard rate limits keep the app inside them.
- Regulatory: the product shows simulated historical performance to people who may act on it. Terms, Privacy and Risk Disclaimer pages exist.

What the pitch does not contain

The founder has not stated any of the following. Treat them as gaps, not as facts to fill in:

- How the product will ever make money, or whether it needs to.

- Who the target user is, specifically (beginner investors? active traders? students?), and how many such people there are.
- How users will find it beyond shareable result links: any marketing or distribution plan.
- Named competitors, or how Stratoscan compares with them.
- Any user research, interviews, waitlist or early interest.
- The founder's goal for the project (a business, a portfolio piece, a learning project, a side income).
- What an investment would be used for, and how much is being asked for.
- What happens to running costs if usage grows beyond the free tiers.

Filling any of these in before the session gives the sharks more to judge; leaving them blank puts them on the homework list.

Background: the earlier /court trial

A 6-juror `/court` trial of the same case ended in a hung jury, 3 to 3; the full record is in `.court/20261004-150438/` on the same branch. Its conditions for acquittal were to ship the no-signup trial and share links before launch, get a first backtest under 60 seconds, and put numbers on the second-backtest kill criterion. This is context for you only: keep it out of `.shark/pitch.md` so the sharks judge the pitch fresh.